

The second educational entrapment danger is “education servitude.” While the Sidewalker deals with “Lifestyle Servitude,” the Slowlaner wrestles with “Education Servitude” (freedom eroded by education) that traps the victim to a job. Has your education indentured you to a job? Advanced degrees are not cheap. According to The College Board the average college degree, including room and board, now costs nearly \$60,000. Prefer the prestige of a private school? The tab will set you back a Ferrari. This kind of debt buries the dreams of your youth and puts them permanently bound to the Slowlane or worse, the Sidewalk.

Consider the statistics. In 2007, the *Washington Post* reported that, according to Nellie Mae, the big student loan service provider, by the time college students are seniors, 56% of them will have four or more credit cards with an average balance of \$2,864. According to a research report by Demos-USA.org, a public policy research and advocacy organization, people in the 18–24 age bracket spend nearly 30% of their monthly income on debt repayment. This is double from 20 years ago. A survey of college borrowers found that the average college senior graduated with nearly \$19,000 in student loan debts, and graduate degree pursuers more than \$45,000. A 2007 Charles Schwab survey revealed that teenagers believe when they get older they will earn an average salary of \$145,000. The reality? Adults with a college degree earned an average of \$54,000. Unfortunately, the future isn’t so bright that you have to wear shades. The truth behind reality and expectation is about a \$100,000 chasm. This disparity might explain why the debts of our youth have exploded as they bridge their reality to expectation. *If I can’t make \$145,000, I can look like I make \$145,000!*

The best excuse people have for not having wealth is “I don’t have time.” Well, why don’t you have time? Because you have a job. Why do you have a job? Because you need one. Why do you need one? Because you have bills to pay. Why do you have bills to pay? Because you have debt. Why do you have debt? Oh yes, because you went to school for six years and have six figures in student loans.

If you financed your advanced education with debt, the debt automatically becomes parasitic and traps you into forced job servitude, and that destroys freedom. While you might earn more, work is forced to stave off the debt. The debt is parasitic because it fails to free time and instead creates indentured time. Sadly, the parasitic debt is unforgiving and isn’t sympathetic to the source. Whether you owe \$35,000 for your awesome BMW or for student loans, debt steals freedom and forces indentured time.

CHAPTER SUMMARY: FASTLANE DISTINCTIONS

- Slowlaners attempt to manipulate intrinsic value by education.
- Indentured time is time you spend earning a living. It is the opposite of free time.
- Parasitic debt is debt that creates indentured time and forces work.